Managing Coupons in WooCommerce

Coupons: Overview

WooCommerce comes with built-in coupon creation and management tools. WooCommerce core offers fixed-cart, fixed-product, and percentage-based coupons. Here you'll learn how to:

- Activate coupons in your store.
- Create a coupon.
- Set "Usage Restrictions" and "Usage Limits" for coupons.

Activating Coupons in WooCommerce

Before creating your first coupon, you'll need to enable coupon use in your store. Enable coupons by following these instructions:

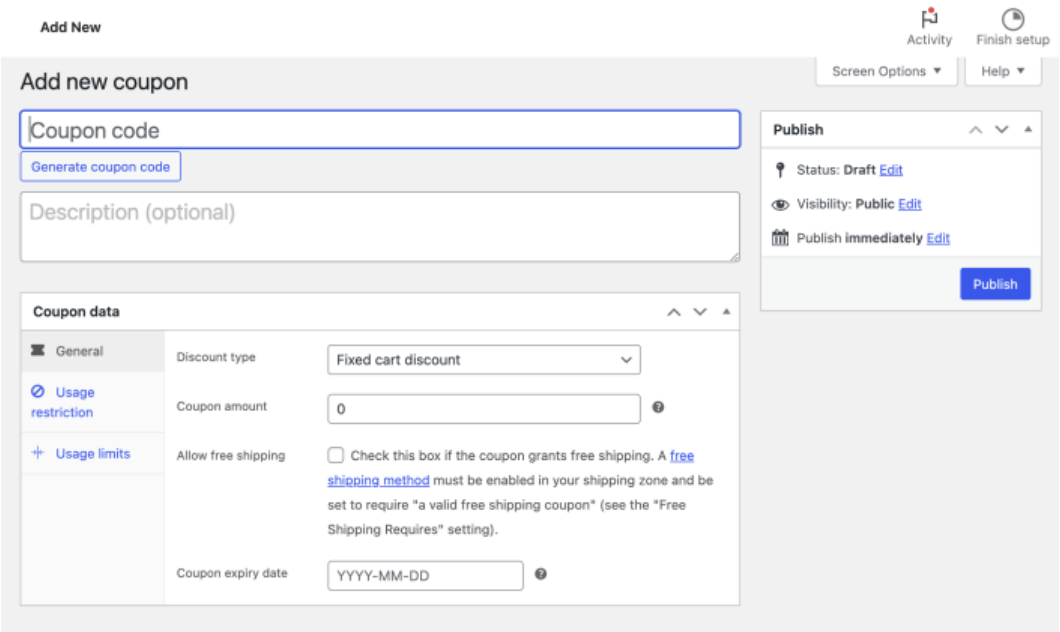
1. Navigate to: **WooCommerce > Settings > General > Enable coupons**
2. Tick the checkbox to **Enable the use of coupon codes**.
3. **Save Changes**.

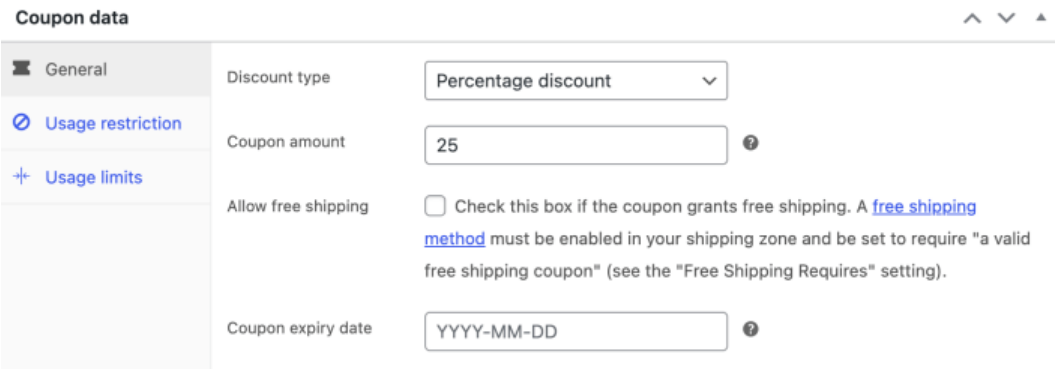
Creating/Adding a Coupon in WooCommerce

The first step to offering coupons to your customers is to create one. Follow these instructions to create a coupon in WooCommerce:

1. Navigate to: **Marketing >Coupons**.
    - If no coupons exist in your store yet, you'll see a screen prompting you to create your first coupon.
    - There's also a button to learn more about coupons, which is how you might've ended up reading this document.
    - If you've made a coupon previously, you will see a list of coupons, their type, discount, etc…
2. Create a new coupon by selecting the **Add new coupon** button at the top of the screen.
3. Enter or generate a **Coupon code**. This is the code your customers use on the cart or checkout pages to apply the discount. You have two options for generating a code:
    - **Create/Enter a code** — Enter a coupon code in the Coupon Code field. You can include letters, numbers, and special characters (such as &, $, -, or @). Coupon codes aren't case-sensitive, so "SAVE10" and "save10" will both work.
    - **Generate a Random Cod**e — Select the **Generate coupon code** button if you want WooCommerce to auto-create a coupon code for you.

4. **Enter** a Description (optional). This is information about the coupon for internal use (not seen by customers) like name of promotion/event, dates the coupon is valid, ticket number, customer name, etc.
5. **Select** the "Discount Type" from the dropdown menu. There are three choices:
    - **Percentage discount** — A percentage discount for selected products only. For example, if the cart contains three (3) t-shirts @ $20 each = $60, a coupon for 10% off applies a discount of $6.
    - **Fixed cart discount** — A fixed total discount for the entire cart. For example, if the cart contains three (3) t-shirts @ $20 each = $60, a coupon for $10 off gives a discount of $10.
    - **Fixed product discount** — A fixed total discount for selected products only. Customers receive a set amount of discount per item. For example, three (3) t-shirts @ $20 each with a coupon for $10 off applies a discount of $30.
6. **Enter** the coupon amount. Enter the amount without currency (i.e. : $, £) or percent (%) signs, regardless of the discount type you chose in the previous step. If you want to offer a discount of 10%, you'll enter `10` in the field.
7. Check the box for "Allow Free Shipping" if applicable. You use this box when creating a "free shipping" coupon to use with the free shipping method.
8. Set a coupon expiry date (optional). Coupons expire/cannot be used on the date that is set.
9. Click the "Publish" button on the right-hand side if you do not need to add any usage restrictions or usage limits (covered in the next section).

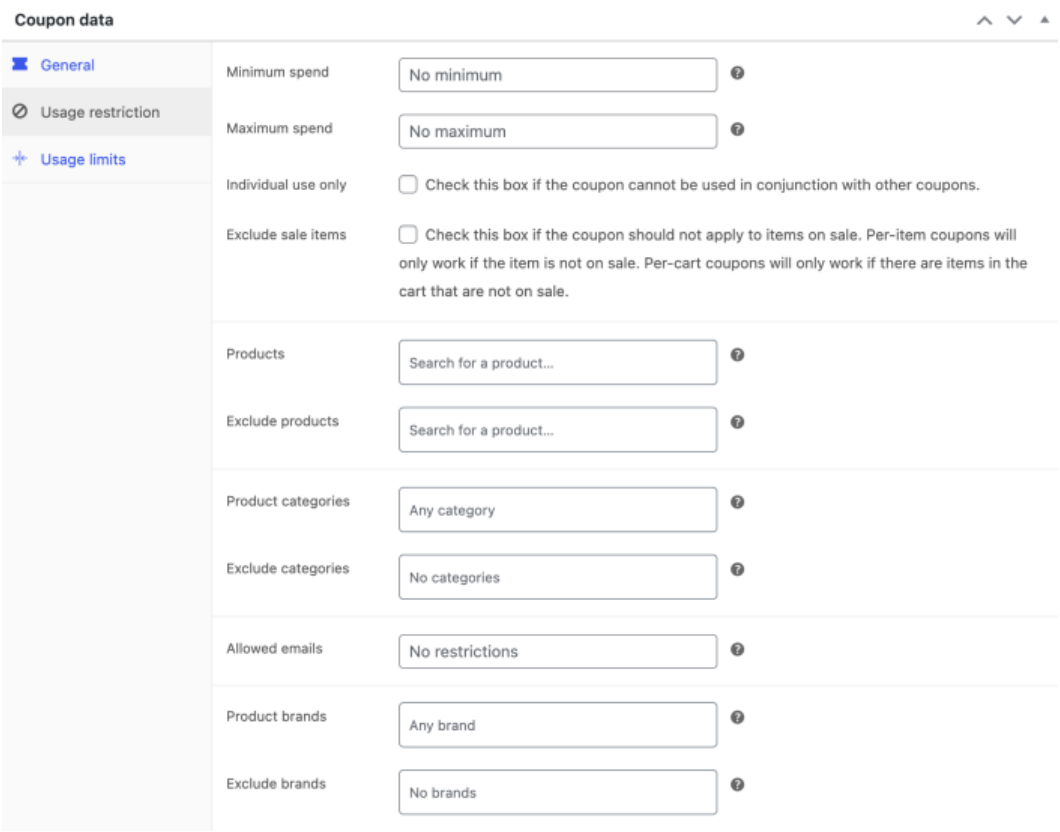

Add New
Activity
Finish setup
Screen Options
Help
Add new coupon
Coupon code
Generate coupon code
Description (optional)
Publish
Status: Draft Edit
Visibility: Public Edit
Publish immediately Edit
Publish
Coupon data
General
Usage restriction
Usage limits
Discount type
Fixed cart discount
Coupon amount
0
Allow free shipping
Check this box if the coupon grants free shipping. A free shipping method must be enabled in your shipping zone and be set to require "a valid free shipping coupon" (see the "Free Shipping Requires" setting).
Coupon expiry date
YYYY-MM-DD


Coupon data
General
Usage restriction
Usage limits
Discount type
Percentage discount
Coupon amount
25
Allow free shipping
Check this box if the coupon grants free shipping. A free shipping method must be enabled in your shipping zone and be set to require "a valid free shipping coupon" (see the "Free Shipping Requires" setting).
Coupon expiry date
YYYY-MM-DD

Setting Coupon Usage Restrictions and Usage Limits

Coupons have two other settings tabs used for the configuration of coupons: Usage Restrictions and Usage Limits. Below, we provide detailed descriptions of each of the options in these tabs.

Configuring Coupon Usage Restrictions



This image shows the coupon usage restriction settings. If your settings differ from the screenshot above, it may be due to additional plugins or customizations.

In the usage restrictions menu are options to restrict the use of the coupon to certain cart totals, products, and customers. Below, we describe each type of restriction that you can apply to a coupon:

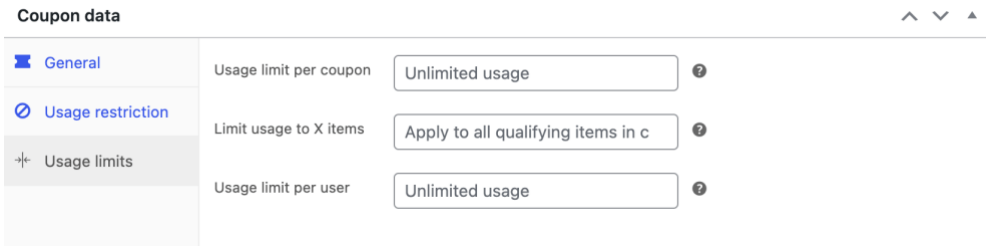
- **Minimum spend —** Set the minimum subtotal needed to use the coupon. **Note**: WooCommerce uses the sum of cart subtotal + tax to determine the minimum amount.
- **Maximum spend —** Set the maximum subtotal allowed when using the coupon.
- **Individual use only —** Tick the box if the coupon cannot be used in combination with other coupons.
- **Exclude sale items** — Tick the box if the coupon does not apply to products on sale. Per-cart coupons don't work when a sale item is added afterward.
- **Products —** The coupon can be applied to these specific products, or these products must be in the cart for the coupon discount to apply.
- **Exclude products —** You cannot apply the coupon to these specific products, or these products cannot be in the cart for the coupon discount to apply.
- **Product categories —** The coupon applies to only these categories or requires specific categories in the cart for the discount to apply.
- **Exclude categories —** The coupon does not apply to these categories, or specific categories must not be in the cart for the coupon discount to apply.
- **Allowed Emails/Email restrictions** — These are email addresses that can use a coupon. Verified against customer's billing email. WooCommerce also allows you to include a wildcard character (*) to match multiple email addresses, for example, `*@gmail.com` would allow any @gmail.com email address to use the coupon.

Note:

Leaving "Products" and "Exclude Products" empty allows the coupon to be applied to all products in your store.

Configuring Coupon Usage Limits

Usage limits specify how many times customers can use a coupon. There are three ways to limit coupon usage:

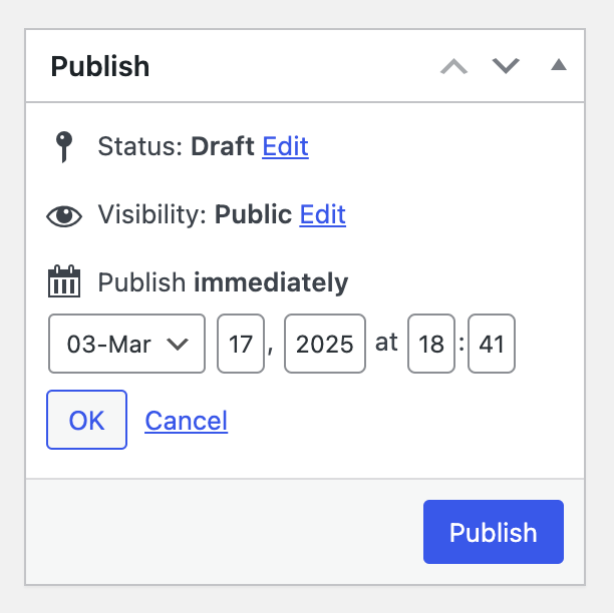


This image shows the coupon usage limit settings. If your settings differ from the screenshot above, it may be due to additional plugins or customizations.

- **Usage limit per coupon —** Each coupon has a usage limit indicating how many times all customers can use it before it becomes invalid.
- **Limit usage to X items —** Customers can apply the coupon to a maximum of X items before it becomes invalid. **Note:** This field only works if specific products are added to the products field in "Usage Restrictions".
- **Usage limit per user —** Each customer can use the coupon a certain number of times before it becomes invalid specifically for that customer.

Once you've configured all settings, select **Publish** and your coupon is ready to use.

If you do not want the coupon to be immediately available, you can schedule it to become available on a future date/time using the option in the Publish settings:



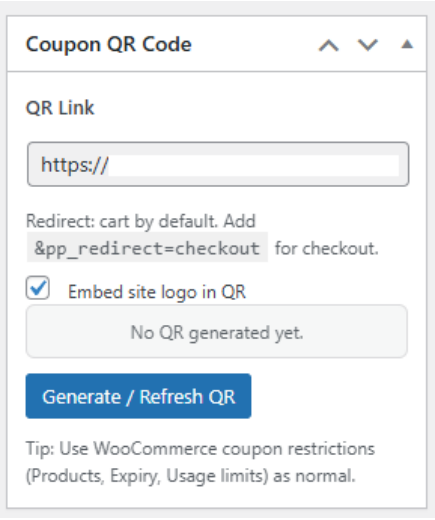
Generate QR code for coupon

On the right side of the coupon edit screen you'll see: **Coupon QR Code**.

QR Link: This is the direct link encoded into the QR code. Scanning the QR opens this link and applies the coupon.

Embed site logo in QR (optional toggle): If enabled, the QR will include your site logo in the middle. This requires your Site Logo to be set: Appearance - Customize - Site Identity - Logo.

Generate / Refresh QR: Click Generate / Refresh QR The QR image will appear in the box.Click **Open QR Image** to download or view it.

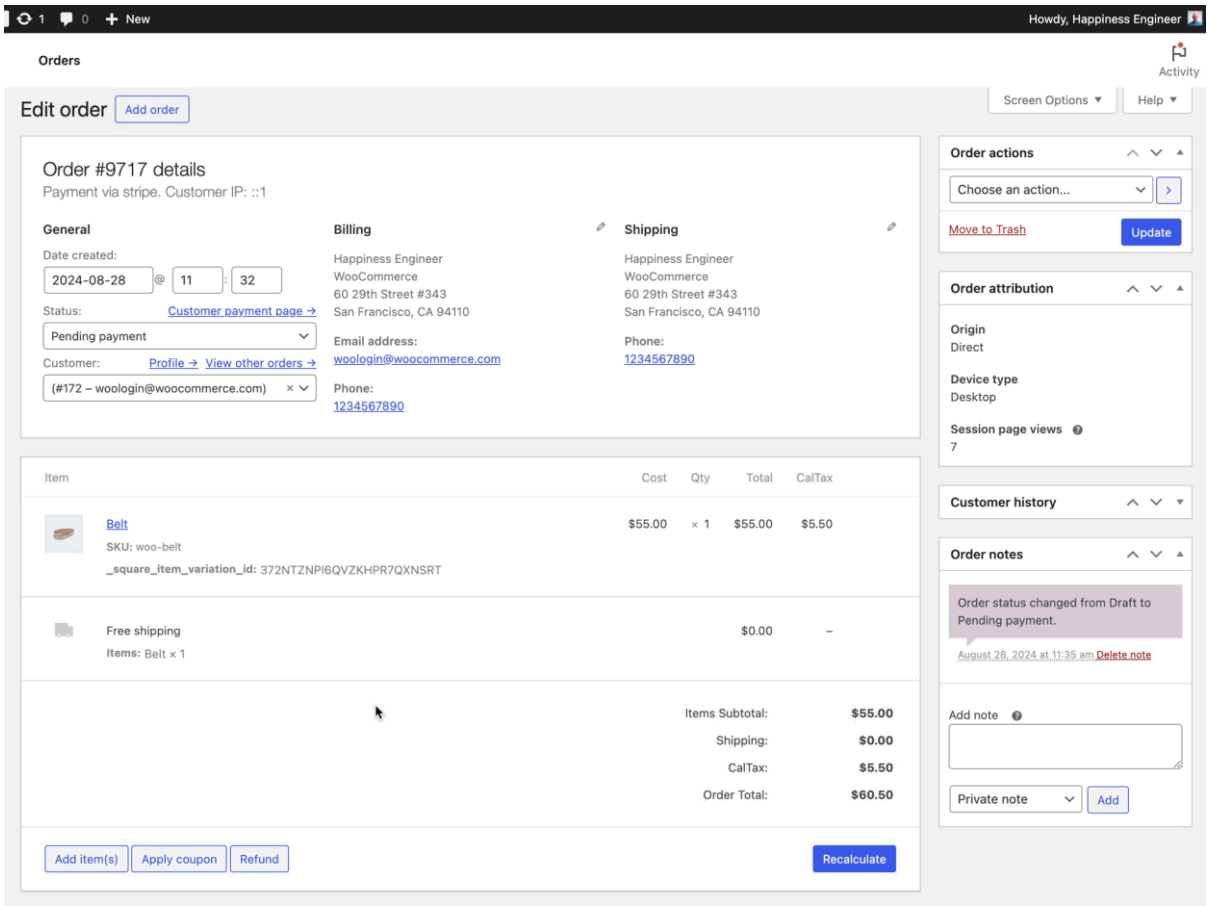


Applying a coupon

Customers apply coupon codes on the cart/checkout pages by clicking the “Add Coupon” link. They then enter the coupon into the box and click “Apply” to add the discount to their order. Customers may also scan QR code and automatically apply coupon code.

Customers will see an error message appear indicating why the coupon cannot be applied if it is not valid..(i.e. When a coupon expires).

Store managers can also add coupons to manually created orders by clicking the “Apply coupon” button at the bottom of the order details. These same steps also apply to an “unpaid” customer order.

Here are a few important notes about coupon discounts and how they are applied:

- **Taxes:** Coupons apply to product prices before tax calculation to ensure accurate tax calculation, preventing rounding errors by splitting the discount between each product in the cart. This behavior is more noticeable with Fixed Cart Discounts.
- **Shipping:** Coupons do not affect shipping since they can only apply to cart items. Shipping is not a cart item. Therefore, if a customer has a coupon covering the entire cost of the products in their cart but your store charges a $10 shipping fee, they will still pay the $10 shipping fee. The only exception is when you create a coupon for free shipping.